

# YOUR COURT HEARING SCRIPT

**Prepared for:** Marcus J. Williams

This script helps you speak to the judge. You can bring this paper with you.

**WHEN YOUR CASE IS CALLED:** Walk to the front of the courtroom.

**You:** Good morning/afternoon, Your Honor. My name is Marcus J. Williams.

**Judge:** Do you have an attorney?

**You:** No, Your Honor. I am representing myself.

**Judge:** Have you filed your Answer?

**You:** Yes, Your Honor. Here is a copy. (hand judge a copy of your Answer)

**Judge:** Do you owe the rent?

**You:** Your Honor, I dispute the amount claimed. I would like to explain why.

**EXPLAIN YOUR DEFENSE:** Now tell the judge:

**YOUR DEFENSES (tell the judge):**

1. The landlord failed to make necessary repairs despite being notified.
2. I did not receive proper legal notice of the eviction.
3. I do not owe the amount the landlord claims.

**IF YOU NEED MORE TIME:**

**You:** Your Honor, I respectfully request additional time to resolve this matter.

**CLOSING:**

**You:** Thank you for hearing me, Your Honor.

**TIPS:** Dress neatly. Turn off your phone. Do not interrupt. Bring all documents. Speak clearly and respectfully. If you don't understand a question, ask the judge to repeat it.